

ADARSH KUMAR

Staff Software Engineer | Fintech & Payment Infrastructure

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Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia (Relocating to the UK, Eligible for Skilled Worker visa; seeking sponsoring employer)

Professional Summary

Staff-level software engineer with nearly a decade building and scaling regulated fintech and payment infrastructure across five Southeast Asian markets. Specialises in the systems that move money — multi-bank routing, real-time reconciliation, double-entry ledgers, and PCI-DSS-aligned platforms built on event-driven, distributed architectures. Took systems from zero to 500K+ users, co-founded a venture-backed startup (\$480K pre-seed, \$1.37M GMV), and led engineering teams across multiple countries.

Work Experience

StashAway | *Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia*

Senior Staff Engineer (Apr 2024 – Present)

- **Money movement & AML compliance:** Own end-to-end deposit, cash-in, and withdrawal flows for 500K+ users across 5 SEA markets; built AML transaction monitoring, sanctions screening, and regulatory reporting aligned with each market's central-bank framework — equivalent to UK PSD2 payment-services rules.
 - **Platform modernisation:** Decomposed the monolith into 12+ microservices on an event-driven architecture (Kafka); led a zero-downtime migration that cut release cycles 40% and enabled 3x traffic-spike handling during market volatility.
 - **Onboarding conversion:** Consolidated KYC/auth from an 8-screen to a 4-screen flow with OAuth2 + MFA and parallelised background checks; signup time down 35%, conversions 10% over target.
 - **Reliability & DR:** Built DR playbooks (DB failover, cross-region backup, fallback handling) and established on-call rotations and structured incident reviews, reducing MTTR.
 - **Infrastructure cost reduction:** Cut AWS staging costs 30% (~\$180K/year) via automated scheduling, Datadog-driven right-sizing, and Terraform cost tagging.
 - **API standards & AI tooling:** Defined versioned API contracts across 12+ services (OpenAPI, consistent errors, pagination); introduced MCP-based automated code review and test generation, cutting review turnaround 50% and lifting shipping speed 25%.
 - **Mentorship:** Built a structured program for 8 engineers — architecture walkthroughs, pair-programming rotations, and monthly tech talks.
 - **Cross-functional collaboration:** Worked with product, compliance, and data science across 5 countries; translated each market's regulatory requirements into platform features without slowing delivery.
- Stack:** Node.js, React Native, Go, Temporal, Kafka, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, AWS, Kubernetes, Datadog, Sentry

Xendit (YC S15) | *Philippines, Indonesia & Malaysia*

Technical Lead (Sep 2022 – Feb 2024) — returned to Xendit after co-founding On Demand Deals |
Senior Software Engineer (Feb 2021 – Aug 2021)

- **Payment routing engine:** Built a real-time routing engine with automatic failover across 30+ banks and e-wallets on \$15B+/year volume; processing time 8s to 2.4s, success rate 88% to 97%.
 - **Resilience:** Built fault-isolation and circuit-breaker layers in a distributed, event-driven system with fault tolerance during 10K+ QPS peaks; sustained 99.99% availability through market-volatility surges.
 - **Reconciliation & idempotency:** Implemented payout retry and reconciliation using the outbox pattern and idempotency keys (PCI-DSS aligned); zero lost or double-processed transactions.
 - **Storage & cost:** Optimised 500M+ transaction records with S3 lifecycle tiering, DB indexing, and read replicas; S3 costs down 65%, DB costs down 40%, p99 latency under 200ms.
 - **Unified notifications:** Delivered a transactional service across WhatsApp, SMS, Viber, and email with automatic fallback; 99.5% delivery across 10M+ monthly messages.
 - **Leadership:** Led a 12-person team (TDD, code-review standards, retros), lifting delivery velocity 35%; core member of the Architecture Review Group, cutting cross-team review time 80%.
 - **Observability:** Built real-time Datadog/Grafana dashboards and alerting for payment success rates, partner health, and circuit-breaker state across all channels.
- Stack:** Node.js, Go, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, AWS, Datadog, Sentry, Splunk, Databricks, Redash

On Demand Deals | *Manila, Philippines*

Co-Founder & CTO (Aug 2021 – Sep 2022)

- **Zero to product-market fit:** Co-founded a SaaS platform for F&B businesses; owned all technical decisions, hiring, and product delivery. Built the platform solo initially, then hired and led a team of 4.
- **Fundraising:** Closed \$480K pre-seed from Iterative (YC for Southeast Asia) and Accelerating Asia; led the financial model and technical due diligence.
- **Growth:** Scaled to 50+ locations across Manila in 6 months; \$1.37M GMV with 200% MoM growth at peak. Managed payment, POS, and delivery-partner integrations.

Stack: React, React Native, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS, Terraform, Kafka

PDAX (Philippines Digital Assets Exchange) | *BGC, Philippines*

Senior Software Engineer (Nov 2019 – Feb 2021) | Software Engineer (Mar 2018 – Nov 2019)

- **Founding engineer:** Joined pre-launch on the core team that grew PDAX into a top-3 BSP-regulated crypto exchange in the Philippines.
- **Trade matching engine:** Built a core engine handling 5K+ concurrent orders at sub-100ms latency, designed for horizontal scaling during volatility spikes; 99.9%+ uptime through major market events.
- **Wallet & ledger:** Built a double-entry wallet and ledger infrastructure across crypto and fiat with full auditability for BSP KYC/AML compliance.
- **Bank & e-wallet integrations:** Connected major banks (BDO, BPI, UnionBank) and e-wallets (GCash, PayMaya) for fiat rails; settlement 3 days to near real-time.
- **Risk & compliance tooling:** Built an admin dashboard and real-time monitoring for suspicious trading patterns, large withdrawals, and KYC checks.
- **Product launch:** Designed and launched a first-of-its-kind blockchain-based fuel-futures product, driving adoption among non-crypto-native users.

Stack: Node.js, PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, Redis, React Native, Solidity, AWS, Web3, ERC20

Primus Software Corporation | *Greater Noida, India*

Software Engineer (Sep 2017 – Mar 2018)

- Built web/mobile apps for healthcare, logistics, and education clients; led 3 pre-sales PoCs that won client contracts.

Technical Skills

Languages: JavaScript, Typescript, Go, Solidity

Backend/Frontend: Node.js, NestJS, Temporal Workflows, REST, gRPC, n8n, React, React Native, Redux

Architecture: Event-driven architecture, distributed systems, microservices, CQRS, outbox pattern, idempotency

Payments & Compliance: Multi-bank routing, Open Banking-style integrations, AML/KYC, sanctions screening, double-entry ledgers, PCI-DSS, payment-services regulation (PSD2/FCA-equivalent)

AI & LLM: MCP, RAG pipelines, vector DBs (Pinecone, pgvector), LLM context management, agentic workflows

Data & Storage: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis, Pinecone, TimescaleDB

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, Docker, CI/CD

Messaging & Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS, Flink

Observability: Datadog, Grafana, PagerDuty, OpsGenie, Sentry, Splunk

Data & Analytics: Databricks, Redash, Looker, Metabase

Education

Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science 2014 – 2018

G.L. Bajaj Institute of Technology & Management — Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University, India

Languages

English (CEFR C1 — IELTS Academic 7.0)